Here are the steps to create your first Laravel 12 web application:

1.8.4.1 Step 1: Open Terminal or Command Prompt

Open your terminal (macOS/Linux) or Command Prompt / PowerShell (Windows).

1.8.4.2 Step 2: Create a New Laravel Project

Navigate to the directory where you want to create your Laravel project and run:

```
composer create-project laravel/laravel:^12.0 myfirstapp
```

This will create a new Laravel 12 project in a folder named `myfirstapp`.

1.8.4.3 Step 3: Open the Project in Visual Studio Code

```
cd myfirstapp
code .
```

> *`code .` will open the current directory in Visual Studio Code. Make sure `code` command is available in your terminal. You can install it from within VS Code: `Cmd+Shift+P` > `Shell Command: Install 'code' command in PATH`.*

1.8.4.4 Step 4: Explore the Project Structure

In VS Code, review the following directories: - `app/Http/Controllers`: where you will define controllers - `routes/web.php`: defines the web routes - `resources/views`: Blade templates for HTML views - `.env`: environment configuration file

1.8.4.5 Step 5: Run Laravel's Built-in Development Server

In the terminal (inside VS Code or system terminal), run:

```
php artisan serve
```

You will see output similar to:

```
Starting Laravel development server: http://127.0.0.1:8000
```